

EXPERIMENT 2

Setting up a Zoho Creator account and exploring the platform architecture and interface.

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Subject: Low Code Development

1. AIM

To set up a Zoho Creator account, create a sample Corporate Asset Maintenance & Service Management System application, and explore the creation of forms, reports, dashboards, and the Develop, Deploy, and Manage sections of the Zoho Creator platform.

2. SETTING UP ZOHO CREATOR

1) Create the Sample Application

Application Name: Corporate Asset Maintenance & Service Management System

ABC Technologies manages several corporate assets such as laptops, desktops, printers, projectors, networking devices, and UPS systems across multiple departments. A sample Corporate Asset Maintenance & Service Management System was created in Zoho Creator to automate the complete asset maintenance process, starting with the Department and Asset Details forms.

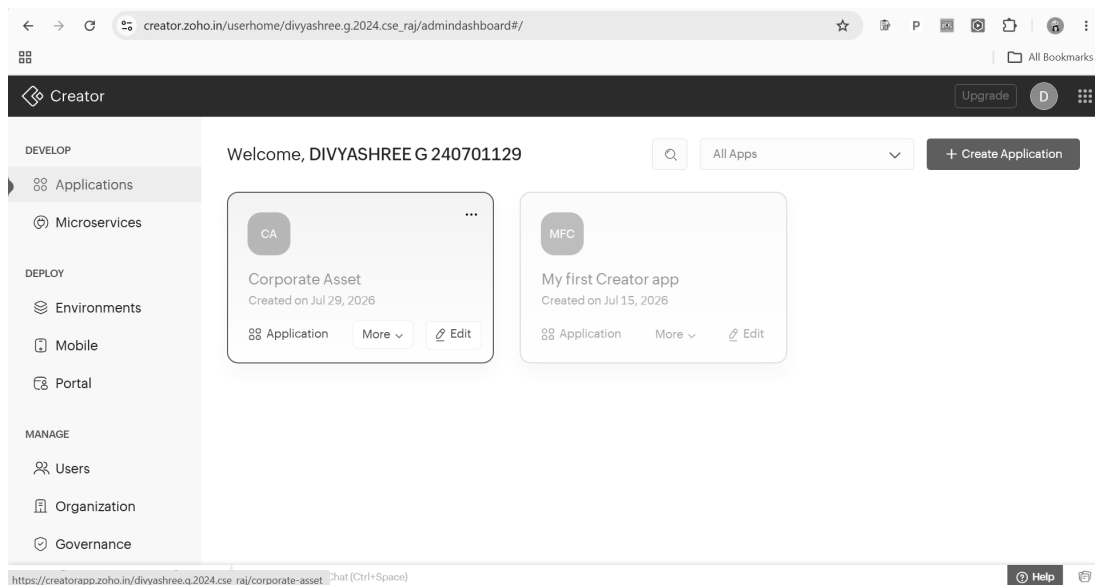


Fig 1: Zoho Creator home page showing the "Corporate Asset" application created from scratch.

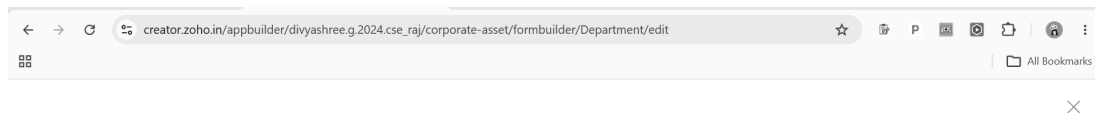
Department Form

The Department form is used to collect and store information about each department in the organization.

Steps:

- 1 Open the Corporate Asset application.
- 2 Click the + icon and go to Create New Component.
- 3 Select Form.
- 4 Enter the form name: Department.

5 Add the required fields.



Create New Component
Create your component from scratch



Form



Report



Page



Workflow

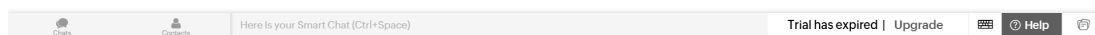


Fig 2: Create New Component dialog showing Form, Report, Page and Workflow options.

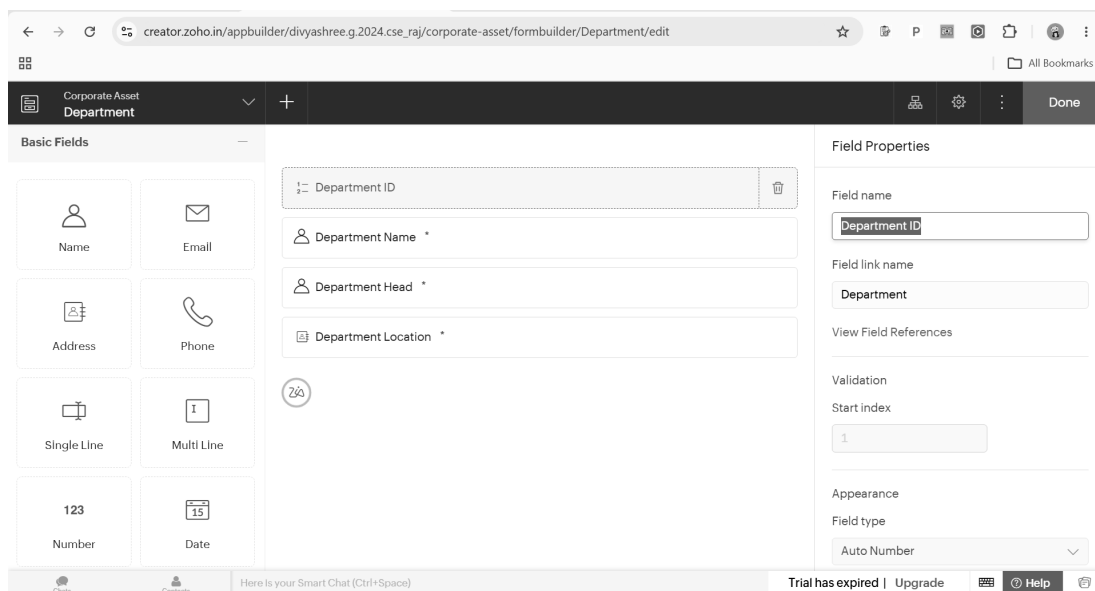


Fig 3: Department form builder with the Department ID field configured as an Auto Number field.

Fields included:

- Department ID (Auto Number)
- Department Name (Single Line)
- Department Head (Single Line)
- Department Location (Single Line)

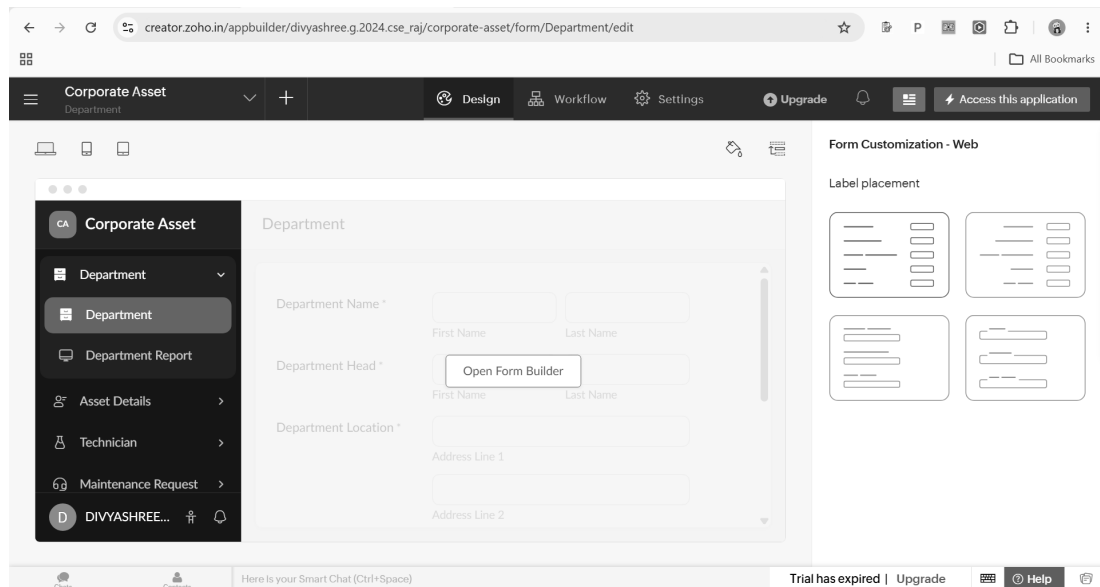


Fig 4: Department form in Design view, showing Department Name, Department Head and Department Location fields.

Explanation:

The Department form collects important information about each department, such as its name, head and location. The submitted information is stored in the application database and can be viewed through the Department Report. A similar Asset Details form was created to record Asset ID, Asset Name, Asset Category and Asset Serial Number for every company asset.

II) Creating Reports

Reports are used to display and organize the data submitted through forms.

The Department Report displays all the department records entered through the Department form.

After creating the form:

- 1 Go to Reports.
- 2 Click Create Report.
- 3 Select Department as the form/data source.
- 4 Give the report name: Department Report.
- 5 Select the fields to be displayed.
- 6 Save the report.

Explanation:

The Department Report displays all the department records submitted through the Department form. It provides a structured view of department information such as Department ID, Name, Head and Location, and makes it easier to view, search and manage records.

III) Creating Dashboard

A dashboard was created to provide a graphical overview of the Corporate Asset Maintenance System. The dashboard contains summary information such as Total Assets and Total Maintenance Requests.

- 1 Go to Pages in the application.
- 2 Click Create Page.

- 3 Select Blank Page.
- 4 Name it: Asset Dashboard.
- 5 Add a Panel/Chart component.
- 6 Select the relevant form/report as the data source.

Explanation:

The Asset Dashboard provides a quick overview of important maintenance information. Panels and summary components are used to represent data visually, helping administrators monitor asset and maintenance activities efficiently.

3. EXPLORING THE PLATFORM ARCHITECTURE AND INTERFACE

Develop

- 1 Zoho Creator provides a low-code development environment for creating applications using forms, reports, pages and workflows.
- 2 Users can design application components such as the Department and Asset Details forms using a simple drag-and-drop interface with minimal programming.
- 3 The Develop section is used to create, customize and test the application before deployment.

Deploy

- 1 The Deploy section is used to make the developed application available to end users such as employees, managers and technicians.
- 2 Administrators can configure user access, permissions and application availability for different roles.
- 3 The deployed application can be accessed through supported web and mobile interfaces.

Manage

- 1 The Manage section is used to manage application settings, users, permissions and data.
- 2 Administrators can monitor and maintain the application, including maintenance requests and approvals, after it has been deployed.
- 3 It also allows application components and configurations to be modified whenever required.

RESULT

Thus, a Corporate Asset Maintenance & Service Management System was successfully created using Zoho Creator. A Department form was created along with a corresponding report and a dashboard. The Develop, Deploy and Manage sections of the Zoho Creator platform architecture and interface were also explored successfully.